EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY

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SUSTAINABILITY REPORT







17 PARTNERSHIPS FOR THE GOALS

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 17 PARTNERSHIP FOR THE GOALS

17.2. Relationships to support the goals



17 PARTNERSHIPS FOR THE GOALS

Policies Towards Partnerships for the Goals

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) recognizes that meaningful partnerships are fundamental to achieving sustainable development and creating lasting positive impact in society. In support of Sustainable Development Goal 17 (SDG 17), Partnerships for the Goals, ESSU actively cultivates collaborative relationships with local government units, national government agencies, educational institutions, industry partners, civil society organizations, and international stakeholders to advance education, research, innovation, extension, and community development. Guided by its mandate as a public higher education institution, ESSU promotes a culture of cooperation, knowledge exchange, and shared responsibility. The University leverages strategic partnerships to strengthen institutional capacity, expand opportunities for learners and communities, mobilize resources, and address local and global development challenges through evidence-based and inclusive approaches.

ESSU remains committed to fostering transparent, mutually beneficial, and sustainable partnerships that contribute to the realization of the Sustainable Development Goals. Through collective action and stakeholder engagement, the University continues to empower communities, promote resilience, and support sustainable growth across Eastern Samar and beyond.

Partnerships for the Goals

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) actively establishes and sustains partnerships with local, national, and international organizations to advance sustainable development through education, research, innovation, and community engagement. The University collaborates with government agencies, academic institutions, industry partners, civil society organizations, and development stakeholders to promote knowledge exchange, resource sharing, and collective action. These partnerships strengthen ESSU's contribution to the Sustainable Development Goals while supporting inclusive growth, community resilience, and improved quality of life across the communities it serves.

17.2 Relationships to support the goals

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) has established a robust, multi-layered framework of 192 active institutional partnerships that directly advance United Nations Sustainable Development Goal 17 (Partnerships for the Goals). This strategic balance between local integration and international expansion allows the university to act as a primary catalyst for sustainable development, policy formulation, and academic excellence across the province and beyond. This extensive collaborative network actively reinforces the university's core mission of student development, civic extension, and social accountability by creating sustainable pathways for academic advancement and community empowerment.

In alignment with regional NGO and government collaboration for SDG policy, the ESSU Main Campus anchors the university's linkage development by maintaining 111 partnerships, establishing critical regional baselines with government line agencies, municipal offices, and neighboring institutions like Eastern Visayas State University. These structural frameworks connect the academic institution with local government units and national line agencies, allowing student deployments and faculty research to directly influence provincial social welfare, civic governance, and regional development initiatives.

International collaboration data gathering for the SDGs is driven by the apex of the university's internationalization strategy, which features two active cross-border partnerships with global entities in Thailand and England. These elite, high-level agreements provide the university with valuable channels for international student internships, joint research collaborations, and faculty mobility programs, allowing the institution to successfully transition from local community service to global academic participation and comparative data sharing. To support collaboration for SDG best practices and benchmark industry standards, ESSU manages a solid mid-level network composed of 20 regional linkages across the wider Eastern Visayas region and Cebu, alongside 14 national partnerships in major metropolitan centers like Metro Manila. These connections to high-tier hotels, major corporate offices, national foundations, and specialized medical centers expose students to diverse working

environments, allowing the university to successfully transition learners from theoretical knowledge to professional mastery while adopting nationwide best practices.

Finally, the university's extensive collaboration with NGOs and grassroots organizations for the SDGs forms the foundational tier of its network, encompassing 156 highly localized partnerships that operate heavily within the immediate municipalities and provincial sectors of Eastern Samar. Through the aggressive community commitment of satellite campuses—such as the Salcedo Campus with 26 partners and the Can-avid Campus with 22 partners—the university embeds its operations directly into agricultural networks, municipal offices, barangay units, and local high schools to bridge the gap between classroom instruction and rural development.

17.2.1 Relationships with Regional NGOs and Government for SDG Policy

Institutional linkages and partnerships development report (CY 2025) File

Eastern Samar State University continues to solidify its role in regional development and global educational standards by expanding its network of institutional linkages across the province. For the Calendar Year 2025, the university has successfully managed and sustained a total of 192 active partnerships distributed strategically among its six campus sites. These collaborative frameworks connect the academic institution with local government units, national line agencies, agricultural enterprises, and private corporations. This extensive collaborative network actively reinforces the university's core mission of student development, civic extension, and social accountability by creating sustainable pathways for academic advancement and community empowerment.

The distribution of these 192 institutional alliances highlights the specific operational focus and community integration of each campus. The ESSU Main Campus serves as the primary anchor for the university's linkage development, holding a commanding total of 111 partnerships, which includes two prominent regional listings. Following the central campus, the satellite institutions demonstrate an aggressive commitment to extension and field placement work, led by the ESSU Salcedo Campus with 26 active partners and the ESSU Can-avid Campus with 22 partners. The remaining specialized collaborations are managed by the ESSU Maydolong Campus with 13 active partners, while the ESSU Guiuan Campus and the ESSU Arteche Campus maintain 10 targeted partnerships each, completing a well-rounded institutional network.

The centralized concentration of 111 partnerships at the ESSU Main Campus accounts for roughly 58% of the university's total network and establishes critical regional baselines, such as collaborations with neighboring institutions like Eastern Visayas State University. This vast network heavily supports the student body through large-scale internship and job placement initiatives, successfully connecting urban academic programs with established corporate and governmental sectors. Meanwhile, the robust strategic alliances in Salcedo and

Can-avid demonstrate an exceptional capacity for localization, embedding university operations directly into agricultural networks, municipal social welfare offices, and local high schools to bridge the gap between classroom instruction and rural development.

A highly context-sensitive approach defines the target engagements at the Maydolong, Guiuan, and Arteche campuses, where collaborations are carefully curated to match the unique socioeconomic needs of their immediate service areas. The 13 partners at Maydolong, alongside the 10 partners each at Guiuan and Arteche, represent a deliberate selection of localized alliances that range from hospitality networks to municipal police stations, local marketing firms, and eco-tourism sites. This tailored approach ensures that student deployments and faculty research remain deeply relevant to the immediate community, maximizing the local impact of the university's academic resources.

Table 1
Distribution of ESSU Institutional Partnerships and Operational Focus (CY 2025)

Campus Site	Number of Active Partnerships	Percentage of Total Network	Primary Operational Focus and Sample Partners
ESSU Main	111	58.81%	Linkage development anchor, large-scale internships, corporate/governmental sectors, regional listings (e.g., Eastern Visayas State University).
ESSU Salcedo	26	13.54%	Extension and field placement, agricultural networks, municipal social welfare, local high schools, rural development.
ESSU Can-avid	22	11.46%	Extension and field placement, localization of classroom instruction, agricultural and community networks.
ESSU Maydolong	13	6.77%	Tailored local alliances matching socioeconomic needs, community-specific student deployments, and faculty research.
ESSU Guiuan	10	5.21%	Targeted engagements, hospitality networks, eco-tourism sites, local marketing, municipal police stations.
ESSU Arteche	10	5.21%	Targeted engagements, localized community alliances, student professional mastery.
Total	**192**	**100%**	**Localizing UN Sustainable Development Goals (Quality Education and Partnerships for the Goals)**

The primary overarching objective of managing these 192 active partnerships is to localize the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, with a special emphasis on Quality Education and Partnerships for the Goals. Exposing students to diverse working environments—ranging from provincial engineering offices to local farms—allows the

university to successfully transition learners from theoretical knowledge to professional mastery. This expanding network demonstrates the university's capacity to build lasting institutional frameworks, and these data points will serve as a foundational baseline for the administration to monitor collaboration outcomes, evaluate internship quality, and pursue high-value national and international linkages that elevate the global competitiveness of both learners and educators.

Geographical scope and distribution analysis of institutional partnerships (CY 2025) File

Eastern Samar State University continues to demonstrate its expanding institutional reach and collaborative strength through a diverse network of multi-level alliances. For the Calendar Year 2025, the university possesses 192 active partnerships categorized systematically into local, regional, national, and international tiers. This multi-layered geographical structure enables the institution to address grass-roots community needs while simultaneously capturing broader opportunities for national development and global academic exchange.

The foundational tier of the university network rests upon local-level alliances, which comprise the overwhelming majority of its collaborations with 156 active partnerships. These linkages operate heavily within the immediate municipalities and provincial sectors of Eastern Samar, connecting individual campuses directly with barangay units, public schools, municipal agricultural offices, and provincial stations. This heavy concentration of local agreements ensures that the university remains deeply integrated into its immediate service areas, providing responsive extension work and accessible field training options that directly benefit the local economy and province.

Expanding outward from the province, the university maintains a solid mid-level network composed of 20 regional and 14 national partnerships. The 20 regional linkages stretch across the wider Eastern Visayas region and nearby economic hubs like Cebu, offering students exposure to larger industrial plants, regional line agencies, and specialized medical

centers. The 14 national partnerships connect the university to major corporate offices, high-tier hotels, and national foundations situated in Metro Manila and other major metropolitan centers, allowing the institution to align its training standards with competitive nationwide industries.

The peak of the university internationalization strategy features two active international-level partnerships that connect the institution to global entities based in Thailand and England. These cross-border agreements provide the university with valuable channels for international student internships, research collaboration, and faculty mobility programs. Managing this diverse geographical spectrum across all four tiers confirms the capacity of Eastern Samar State University to maximize its institutional impact, successfully transitioning from local community service to global academic participation.

Table 2
Geographical Distribution of ESSU Institutional Partnerships (CY 2025)

Geographical Tier	Number of Active Partnerships	Percentage of Total Network	Scope and Key Operational Examples
Local Level	156	81.25%	Immediate municipalities and provincial sectors of Eastern Samar; connects campuses with barangay units, public schools, municipal agricultural offices, and provincial stations for grassroots community development
Regional Level	20	10.42%	Spans the wider Eastern Visayas region and economic hubs like Cebu; exposes students to large industrial plants, regional line agencies, and specialized medical centers
National Level	14	7.29%	Major corporate offices, high-tier hotels, and national foundations situated in Metro Manila and other major metropolitan centers; aligns training with competitive nationwide industries
International Level	2	1.04%	Global entities based in Thailand and England; drives cross-border student internships, research collaboration, and faculty mobility programs
Total Network	**192**	**100%**	**Multi-layered geographical structure spanning from grassroots community service to global academic participation**

ESSU and SSS inks deal providing safety net for non-regular employees | 09 December 2025 Facebook

Under the framework of regional government collaboration for sustainable policy development, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) and the Social Security System (SSS) officially entered into a landmark partnership through a Memorandum of Agreement (MOA)

signed at the ESSU Main Campus Faculty Lounge. This institutional alignment directly addresses the social protection gap for the university's non-regular workforce, specifically targeting Contract of Service (COS) and Job Order (JO) personnel who are structurally excluded from the Government Service Insurance System (GSIS). By integrating these workers into the SSS Self-Employed Program, the initiative operationalizes national mandates set forth by Republic Act No. 11199, also known as the Social Security Act of 2018. Executed by SSS Acting Branch Head Troy Ian A. Baclay and ESSU University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr., the agreement establishes permanent administrative safety nets that guarantee critical workforce coverage against sickness, maternity, disability, old age, and death.



University leadership operationalizes national labor directives to secure non-regular workforce employment continuity | 03 December 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. convened a mandatory consultation with the institution's Contract of Service (COS) and Job Order (JO) workforce at the Main Campus Student Pavilion to establish administrative

expectations for contract renewals. This dialogue directly aligned university human resource operations with regional and national government mandates, specifically the Commission on Audit (COA) and Department of Budget and Management (DBM) Joint Circular No. 2, series of 2024. The institutional review integrated a national directive from President Ferdinand R. Marcos, Jr. that extended the labor transition period, allowing state universities to systematically reassess staffing requirements against their organizational structures. Academic and administrative key performance tracking accompanied this policy enforcement, featuring real-time evaluation of the postgraduate progression of lecturers alongside strategic personnel earmarking to guarantee stable public service delivery.



Congressional committee convenes national education leaders to advance legislative reforms for tertiary institutions | 18 November 2025 Facebook

The Congressional Committee on Higher and Technical Education (CHTE), under the leadership of Chairperson Representative Jude Acidre, convened its 3rd Regular Meeting to deliberate on critical national legislative measures aimed at upgrading the regulatory framework of Philippine tertiary education. Commission on Higher Education (CHED)

Chairperson Dr. Shirley C. Agrupis participated directly in the high-level policy dialogue alongside key sectoral stakeholders to advocate for comprehensive operational reforms across local universities and colleges. The structural agenda focused heavily on establishing inclusive administrative policies governing the appointment protocols for academic faculty, researchers, and institutional administrators. This legislative collaboration also targeted the modernization of the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA), driving cohesive state-level policy integration to enhance national academic standards and human resource development frameworks.



DOST audits smart innovation center to validate regional development impacts | 13 November 2025 Facebook

The Department of Science and Technology (DOST) Regional Office deployed a specialized monitoring team to Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) to execute a comprehensive project monitoring and evaluation audit at the Smart Technologies Research, Development, and Innovation Center (STRDIC). Received by Center Director Engr. Elizabeth Z. Calvo, the government evaluators conducted intensive physical asset inspections and

output reviews for the state-funded project, which is currently operating in its second year under the broader "STI Ecosystem Development Toward Smart and Sustainable Program." Administrative data collection confirmed that the partnership has successfully operationalized several regional public utility platforms, including the automated system for Borongan City's Libre Sakay transit program and the Healthsync healthcare inventory tracker for the City Rural Health Unit. This structural alignment with DOST ensures optimal public fund utilization while solidifying collaborative research frameworks across engineering, data science, and mathematics to generate localized technological solutions supporting multiple United Nations Sustainable Development Goals.



State university executes scheduled disaster preparedness protocols linked to national security readiness drill | 06 November 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus faculty and non-teaching personnel temporarily paused remote work operations to execute the state-mandated National Simultaneous Earthquake Drill (NSED). Orchestrated by the University Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Office (UDRRMO) Director Prof. Jayvee Sam C. Depositario

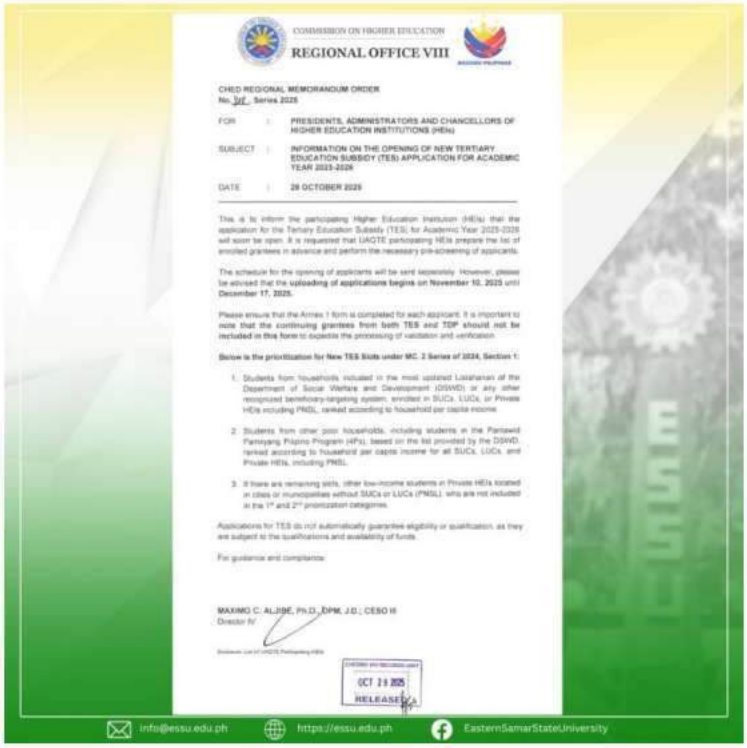
alongside Vice President for Administration Dr. Rhodora C. Mendoza, the institutional exercise synchronized localized crisis response protocols with national civil defense schedules. Executed precisely at 09:00 AM Philippine Standard Time, participants performed standard emergency procedures, including the duck, cover, and hold protocol, followed by organized building evacuations toward designated campus safe zones. Building supervisors completed real-time injury assessments and post-evacuation structural integrity inspections, feeding raw compliance data into the campus Emergency Operations Center (EOC) for consolidation. This institutional simulation establishes proactive disaster coordination in line with national public safety frameworks to minimize future environmental vulnerabilities.



Regional Higher Education Commission issues mandatory directives for TES implementation | 05 November 2025 Facebook

The Commission on Higher Education (CHED) Regional Office VIII issued a formal memorandum order to all regional higher education institutions detailing the compliance framework for the Academic Year 2025–2026 Tertiary Education Subsidy (TES) program. This state directive legally mandates participating institutions to execute advanced pre-screening

protocols and consolidate electronic enrollment lists for potential student grantees. The structural policy enforces strict equity-based financial allocation under Memorandum Circular No. 2, series of 2024, explicitly synchronizing university data verification with the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) Listahanan database and Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps) registries. The directive establishes a rigorous administrative deadline requiring institutions to securely upload validated applicant profiles via the national tertiary subsidy portal between 10 November 2025 and 17 December 2025. This coordinated government framework directly advances socio-economic inclusivity policies by targeting educational subsidies toward low-income demographic sectors across the region.



COMMISSION ON HIGHER EDUCATION
REGIONAL OFFICE VIII

CHED REGIONAL MEMORANDUM ORDER
No. [illegible], Series 2025

FOR : PRESIDENTS, ADMINISTRATORS AND CHANCELLORS OF HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTIONS (HEIs)

SUBJECT : INFORMATION ON THE OPENING OF NEW TERTIARY EDUCATION SUBSIDY (TES) APPLICATION FOR ACADEMIC YEAR 2025-2026

DATE : 28 OCTOBER 2025

This is to inform the participating Higher Education Institution (HEIs) that the application for the Tertiary Education Subsidy (TES) for Academic Year 2025-2026 will soon be open. It is requested that UAQTE participating HEIs prepare the list of enrolled grantees in advance and perform the necessary pre-screening of applicants.

The schedule for the opening of applicants will be sent separately. However, please be advised that the **uploading of applications begins on November 10, 2025** until **December 17, 2025.**

Please ensure that the Annex 1 form is completed for each applicant. It is important to **note that the continuing grantees from both TES and TDP should not be included in this form** to expedite the processing of validation and verification.

Below is the prioritization for New TES Slots under MC. 2 Series of 2024, Section 1:

1. Students from households included in the most updated Listahanan of the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) or any other recognized beneficiary-targeting system, enrolled in SUCs, LUCs, or Private HEIs including PNSL, ranked according to household per capita income.
2. Students from other poor households, including students in the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps), based on the list provided by the DSWD, ranked according to household per capita income for all SUCs, LUCs, and Private HEIs, including PNSL.
3. If there are remaining slots, other low-income students in Private HEIs located in cities or municipalities without SUCs or LUCs (PNSL), who are not included in the 1st and 2nd prioritization categories.

Applications for TES do not automatically guarantee eligibility or qualification, as they are subject to the qualifications and availability of funds.

For guidance and compliance.

MAXIMO C. ALJIBE, Ph.D., DPM, J.D.; CESO III
Director IV

OCT 28 2025
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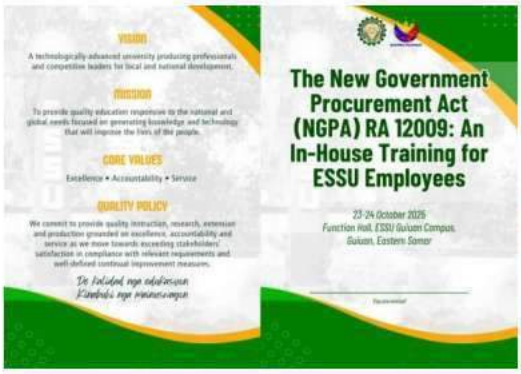
DBM collaborates with ESSU to operationalize national procurement reforms | 26 October 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Guiuan Campus conducted an intensive two-day institutional training seminar to operationalize the statutory mandates of the New Government Procurement Act, also known as Republic Act No. 12009. Spearheaded by University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. and Vice President for Administration Dr.

Rhodora C. Mendoza, the compliance initiative directly engaged senior executives from the Department of Budget and Management (DBM) Region VIII to align institutional practices with updated state regulations. Chief Budget and Management Specialist Florita M. Lacdo-o and DBM Regional Director Director Imelda C. Laceras delivered structured technical lectures regarding modernized procurement pathways, fiscal accountability standards, and strategic budget-linked planning. This collaborative governance framework ensures strict alignment with Government Procurement Policy Board (GPPB) principles, upgrading the university's internal administrative infrastructure to enforce fiscal transparency, prevent systemic resource waste, and secure public fund efficiency.









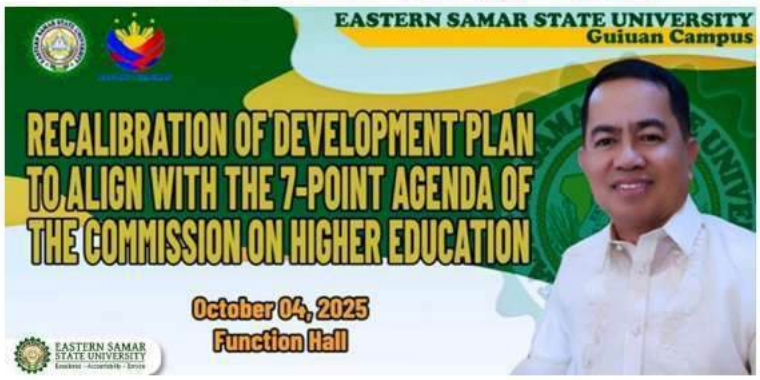
ESSU recalibrates strategic roadmap to institutionalize higher education commission policy reforms | 04 October 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) conducted a major recalibration of its institutional development plan at the ESSU-Guiuan Campus to achieve complete operational synchronization with national higher education directives. Spearheaded by University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. alongside vice presidents and campus administrators,

the strategic realigning directly integrates the Seven-Point Agenda of Commission on Higher Education (CHED) Chairperson Dr. Shirley C. Agrupis and the performance-based mandates of Commissioner Dr. Desiderio R. Apag III. The updated governance framework structures institutional targets around measurable state metrics, embedding outcomes-based education, responsive governance, digital transformation, and regional resource resilience into the university's five-year roadmap. This formalized policy adaptation solidifies ESSU's compliance with national regulatory standards, enabling the multi-campus system to operate as a direct institutional partner in executing state-level educational and sustainable development agendas.









CHR collaborates with ESSU to establish regional human rights education center | 04 October 2025 Facebook

Counterparts from the Commission on Human Rights (CHR) Regional Office VIII convened with Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) key officials to finalize the institutional terms of agreement for the creation of a specialized Center for Human Rights Education (CHRE). Information Officers Jonna Marie M. Ranes and Joseph Roel Obrino, representing

CHR Chairperson Atty. Richard P. Palpal-Latoc, coordinated with ESSU's academic, legal, and research executives to establish the foundational orientation framework for the center. Functioning as a state-partnered academic hub, the CHRE embeds human rights principles directly into higher education systems through localized teaching, human rights research modules, and structural community engagement. This multi-agency alignment successfully set the parameters for a formal, multi-university Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) signing in Catbalogan City, securing institutional compliance with national legal mandates and human rights promotion policies.



Provincial government and higher education commission officers align with ESSU to honor academic faculty | 03 October 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus collaborated with regional government leaders and state education executives to stage its official World Teachers' Day program. Organized by the Student Services and Academic Affairs (SSAA) division under Dean Dr. Aris A. Lapada and the Supreme Student Council, the multi-campus institutional celebration consolidated administrative and student-led honors for the university teaching

workforce at Canuctan Hall. Eastern Samar Provincial Governor Ralph Vincent M. Evardone and Commission on Higher Education Regional Office VIII (CHEDRO8) Director Dr. Maximo C. Aljibe participated as Guests of Honor alongside University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. This synchronized civic-academic assembly reinforced regional development policy objectives by linking provincial governance resource networks, including state-sponsored faculty cash incentives, with the higher education sector to support human capital retention and instructional sustainability throughout the province.







NAP trains ESSU record officers on systematic document disposition | 29 September 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) mobilized record handlers from all extension campuses to undergo specialized training on Records Disposition Administration, executed in direct coordination with the National Archives of the Philippines (NAP). Facilitated by Main Campus Records Officer III Corazon A. Anacio alongside university administrative officers Eleanor Balbin-Sabas and Virginia B. Celada, the capacity-building session functioned as a continuation of the state-level Basic Records & Archives Management framework. Due to

regional infrastructure disruptions caused by Typhoon Opong, the government agencies adjusted operations to a remote hybrid modality to maintain administrative continuity. NAP Records Management Analyst II Jhonley Joseph L. Item spearheaded the technical workshop, instructing personnel on the systematic classification, archiving, and lawful disposal of government documents to enforce public sector transparency and safeguard institutional historical data.



DSWD renews strategic anti-poverty partnership with ESSU | 01 August 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. and the Training and Extension Office (TESO) convened with representatives from the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) Field Office VIII to formalize the renewal of their regional partnership for the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps). Managed by TESO Director Dr. Maria Natalia Ciasico alongside faculty leaders from the College of Technology and the College of Arts and Social Sciences, the multi-sectoral meeting established a restructured, values-driven framework for regional welfare implementation. Institutional monitoring records and past performance data presented during the session guided plans to

scale the anti-poverty collaboration from localized colleges to a unified, university-wide operational model spanning all extension campuses. This collaborative alignment with DSWD Institutional Partnership Officer Reden M. Sabela ensures a synchronized, state-supported approach to tracking and upgrading socio-economic interventions for vulnerable families throughout the province.



ESSU-DILG Governance Center Initiative advances through partnership and consultative meeting | 22 July 2025 Facebook

BORONGAN CITY, EASTERN SAMAR, PHILIPPINES – Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) and the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG), through the Local Government Academy (LGA), Eastern Samar, advanced plans for the establishment of the ESSU-DILG Governance Center during a Partnership and Consultative Meeting held on July 22, 2025, at the Faculty Lounge of the ESSU Main Campus.

The meeting marked a significant milestone following preliminary discussions initiated in November 2024. Representatives from DILG Eastern Samar, led by Cluster Head Mr. Jerry A. Enrique, LGOO VI, together with Ms. Dionesa Marie Apura, LGOO III, and Mr. Jewel

Costuna, LGOO II, met with ESSU officials headed by University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. and Vice President for Academic Affairs Dr. Vicente A. Agda, Jr. to discuss strategic directions for the proposed Governance Center.

Discussions focused on strengthening cooperation between ESSU and DILG in promoting inclusive and responsive governance across Eastern Samar. Participants explored institutional roles and responsibilities, developed initial directions for the Center's programs and operations, and identified opportunities for collaboration among government agencies, civil society organizations, private sector partners, and local communities. The consultation also highlighted the importance of stakeholder engagement in designing governance initiatives that respond to the evolving needs of local government units.

The proposed Governance Center is envisioned as a continuing extension initiative under the University's Training and Extension Services Office (TESO). The Center aims to serve as a dedicated hub for governance education, leadership development, and capacity-building programs for elected and appointed officials from the barangay, municipal, city, and provincial levels. Through the expertise of the Political Science Department and ESSU's institutional capabilities in instruction, training, and community engagement, the University seeks to become an official Learning Resource Institution (LRI) partner of DILG for the delivery of governance-related learning and development programs.

The initiative reflects a shared commitment to strengthening public sector capacity through evidence-based training, professional development, and knowledge exchange. Combining the policy leadership of DILG with ESSU's academic and extension expertise creates opportunities for developing competent, responsive, and accountable local government leaders equipped to address contemporary governance challenges.

Once established, the Governance Center is expected to serve as a multi-sectoral platform that supports good governance, institutional effectiveness, civic participation, and sustainable local development. The partnership between ESSU and DILG demonstrates how collaboration between higher education institutions and government agencies can contribute

to stronger public institutions and advance Sustainable Development Goal 17 through strategic partnerships that generate meaningful and lasting impacts for communities.



17.2.2 Cross-Sectoral Dialogue about SDGs

TESO strengthens community partnerships through stakeholders' meeting and launch of DOST-funded extension programs |10 June 2025 Facebook

BORONGAN CITY, EASTERN SAMAR, PHILIPPINES – Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through its Training and Extension Services Office (TESO), strengthened its engagement with partner communities through a Stakeholders' Meeting and the launch of new extension programs supported by the Department of Science and Technology (DOST).

The activity convened community partners, local stakeholders, and university representatives to discuss priority development concerns and identify collaborative strategies for addressing community needs. The gathering provided an opportunity for participants to share insights, align development goals, and strengthen cooperation in the implementation of extension initiatives designed to generate meaningful and sustainable impact.

A key highlight of the event was the introduction of newly funded DOST-supported extension programs developed in response to the needs and aspirations of partner communities. The programs were designed to promote community development through knowledge transfer, capacity-building activities, and science- and technology-based interventions that support local growth and resilience.

Discussions emphasized the value of stakeholder participation in shaping extension activities that are responsive, inclusive, and community-driven. The engagement enabled ESSU and its partners to strengthen shared ownership of development initiatives while ensuring that programs remain aligned with local priorities and opportunities.

The initiative reflects the University's continuing commitment to building strong relationships with government agencies, community organizations, and other stakeholders in pursuit of sustainable development. Collaboration among academic institutions, funding agencies, and local communities creates opportunities to maximize resources, exchange expertise, and develop solutions tailored to local contexts.

Through TESO's extension programs and stakeholder engagement activities, ESSU continues to advance Sustainable Development Goal 17 by promoting meaningful partnerships that support community empowerment, inclusive development, and long-term sustainability. The activity demonstrates the important role of cross-sectoral collaboration in translating knowledge, innovation, and community participation into positive outcomes for society.



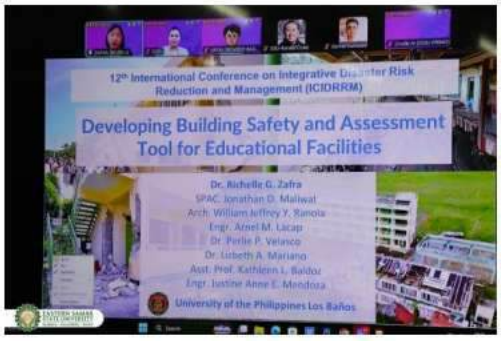


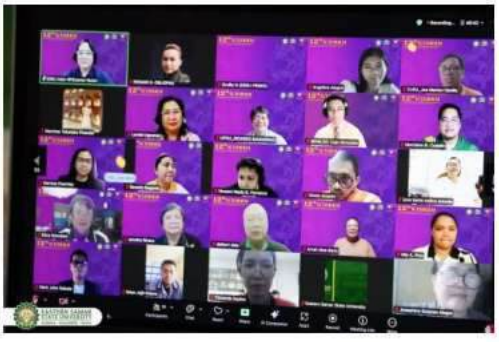
17.2.3 International Collaboration Data Gathering for SDGs

Global research convergence drives academic data exchange for climate and disaster resilience | 05 December 2025 Facebook

Under the global framework of collaborative knowledge exchange and evidence-based tracking for climate resilience, the second day of the 12th International Conference on Integrative Disaster Risk Reduction Management (ICIDRRM) brought together academic researchers from private and state universities across Luzon, Visayas, and Mindanao. The full online conference functioned as an international and multi-institutional data-gathering nexus, anchoring peer-reviewed research presentations across vital thematic lines: disaster risk education, university-community crisis linkages, and policy planning for disaster-resilient tourism destinations. Highlighting this collective data gathering, the University of the Philippines Open University's (UPOU) study on socio-ecological landscape preparedness in Ormoc City clinched the Best Paper award, while researchers from Samar State University (SSU), Isabela State University (ISU), and Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) received accolades for advancing empirical disaster reduction practices. The international data dialogue culminated in critical plenary evaluations of recent localized climate disruptions, featuring a keynote by world-renowned science diplomat Glenn S. Banaguas on recent Philippine typhoons and earthquakes, paired with data-driven public continuity planning insights from the Office of Civil Defense Regional Office VIII.







ESSU students secure top awards in regional community-based monitoring data conventions | 19 September 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus students achieved top institutional placements at the 2025 Regional Community-Based Monitoring System (CBMS) Convention and Data Festival held in Tacloban City, Leyte. Mentored by College of Criminal Justice Education (CCJE) faculty member Dr. Janette Rivera, the student-researchers engaged in high-level data handling competitions designed to evaluate regional demographic tracking and evidence-based analysis capabilities. CCJE student Sharmaine Añosa secured second place in the "Report It Right" data reporting contest, while Glen Rose Cebreros clinched second place in the "VizWiz" data visualization competition. Furthermore, Ron Jacob Cantos partnered with College of Engineering students to complete the "Amazing Stats Race" data-gathering tracker. This active civic-academic participation reinforces state statistical initiatives, providing the university with advanced technical benchmarks to align internal engineering and criminal justice data science curricula with regional public monitoring frameworks.







17.2.4 Collaboration for SDG Best Practice

Cross-border hospitality internships yield global industry performance and skill development data | 29 September 2025 Facebook

Five student-interns from Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Guiuan and Borongan campuses successfully returned to the Philippines on 21 September 2025, after completing a rigorous six-month international training placement at The Peninsula Bangkok in Thailand. Facilitated under the university's Student Internship Abroad Program (SIAP) in cooperation with Outbound Education & Internships Inc. (OBEI), the cohort participated in multi-layered institutional briefings and comprehensive post-travel debriefing sessions in Manila. Academic and administrative coordinators, including Ms. Antonieta Korinne B. Gagatiga, gathered qualitative training data and operational feedback regarding the students' cross-border educational experiences and experiential learning milestones. Supported directly by University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan Jr., the international education program functions as a crucial institutional baseline, providing the university with the global collaborative data necessary to scale cross-border educational opportunities and align local curricula with international industry standards.



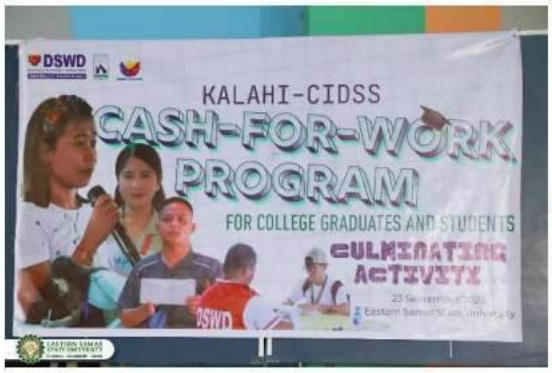
17.2.5 Collaboration with NGOs for SDGs

DSWD integrates multi-agency employment support services for university beneficiaries | 24 September 2025 Facebook

The Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) Eastern Samar Field Office partnered with Eastern Samar State University's (ESSU) Student Services and Alumni Affairs (SSAA) division to execute the culminating payout assembly and employment matching forum for the Cash for Work Program. Held at Canuctan Hall, the state welfare agency distributed direct financial compensation to college graduate and student beneficiaries upon completion of their three-month professional service engagements under the KALAHI-CIDSS framework. To optimize the regional socio-economic intervention, the collaborative governance exercise embedded an active public-private services sector, uniting the Civil Service Commission, Social Security System, PhilHealth, and the Department of Labor and Employment to process immediate career placement files. Specialized technical modules delivered by ESSU Internship Director Dr. Lucila C. Habac synchronized institutional talent development with state-level livelihood mandates, equipping entering workers with core professional competencies required to navigate the provincial economic ecosystem.



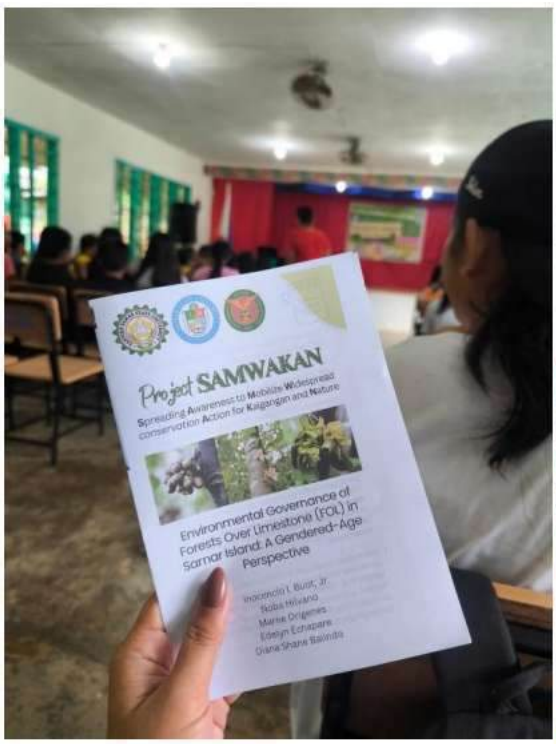






ESSU and local high school partner to deliver environmental governance and conservation education | 14 September 2025 Facebook

Bolusao National High School organized its intensive, three-day School-Based Science Month Celebration centered on technological futures, climate understanding, and natural resource innovation. Organized into four competing student teams, the collaborative science camp integrated high-level academic research into secondary-level community instruction through a formalized partnerships framework. Dr. Noba Hilvano from the Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus served as the keynote resource speaker, delivering critical environmental data on the protection of Samar Island's Forest over limestone ecosystems. This targeted ecological curriculum, executed under Project SAMWAKAN in joint cooperation with Samar State University and the University of the Philippines, provided youth participants with gendered and age-perspective insights regarding regional conservation governance. The academic outreach successfully brought institutional environmental research directly into the wider community, equipping local high school learners with scientific literacy tools necessary to drive local climate and ecological conservation efforts.





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SUSTAINABILITY REPORT







17 PARTNERSHIPS FOR THE GOALS

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 17 PARTNERSHIP FOR THE GOALS

17.4. Education for the SDGs



17 PARTNERSHIPS FOR THE GOALS

17.4 Education for the SDGs

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) integrates a proactive educational philosophy across its academic curriculum to advance global sustainability and ecological preservation. This institutional commitment to meaningful SDG education ensures that sustainability concepts are not treated as isolated themes but are embedded directly into the university's instructional fabric. These educational strategies equip the student body and faculty members with the necessary tools to address complex environmental and economic challenges, successfully transitioning learners from classroom theory to practical regional problem-solving.

The university delivers this educational framework through specific courses on sustainability and specialized degree programs distributed across its six campus sites. Curricula in agriculture, environmental science, technology, and governance incorporate targeted learning modules that analyze resource conservation, renewable energy, and economic equity. This curricular integration guarantees that every student engages with the legal and social dimensions of sustainability, enriching their professional preparation with a solid understanding of responsible production and civic accountability.

The university extends its educational mandate beyond campus boundaries by actively conducting SDG education in the wider community. Satellite campuses lead localized training sessions, agricultural workshops, and seminars for barangay leaders, public school teachers, and municipal personnel throughout Eastern Samar. These outreach initiatives share institutional expertise regarding sustainable farming methods, climate resilience planning, and waste management practices, directly empowering local citizens to implement sustainable solutions within their immediate communities.

The ultimate goal of these combined academic and civic initiatives is the continuous advancement of sustainable literacy among all stakeholders. The institution monitors learning outcomes and community feedback to evaluate the effectiveness of its sustainability training and educational drives. This systematic approach ensures that both the student body and the

broader provincial populace develop a shared responsibility toward natural resource preservation and inclusive social development, securing a lasting baseline for regional progress.

17.4.1 Commitment to Meaningful SDG Education

Institutional strategic planning formalizes long-term development agenda for sustainable governance and innovation | 28 November 2025 Facebook

Demonstrating a formalized commitment to systemic sustainability and progressive institutional governance, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) convened its top management on 14 November 2025, followed by a general workforce forum on 28 November 2025, to operationalize its 2025–2030 Development Plan. Officially ratified under Board of Regents (BOR) Resolution 207, series of 2025, University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr., alongside Vice President for Research, Innovation, and Extension Dr. Aris A. Lapada, presented a comprehensive 7-point development agenda to university administrators, faculty, and staff. This strategic blueprint embeds meaningful sustainability into the university's core operations through prioritizing green architecture, upgrading faculty and staff learning frameworks, enhancing research innovation, and upholding transparent governance. Active engagement with the campus workforce at Canuctan Hall gathered crucial operational inputs, successfully aligning internal administrative infrastructure and educational vision with long-term socio-ecological responsibility.









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BAGONG PILIPINAS

ESSU Main Library deploys virtual services and digital repositories to support flexible academic continuity | 04 November 2026 Facebook

The Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Library officially rolled out its comprehensive online services and electronic resource portals to reinforce asynchronous learning and independent study across the academic community. To ensure continuous access beyond regular classroom hours, the institutional repository provides students, faculty, and administrative staff with remote entry to premier digital databases, including Gale Research Complete, Tritech Digital Media, Bibliotex E-books, and the Philippine E-Journals framework. Access activation requires users to complete a mandatory pre-registration screening form, after which university librarians securely transmit localized login details via email. The library's digital framework also features real-time virtual research assistance through its chat-based reference support alongside an academic document delivery service for scanned materials. This coordinated educational infrastructure directly strengthens the university's capacity to maintain high-quality instruction and scholarly equity within flexible learning environments.



ESSU guidance center deploys virtual psychological support infrastructure for institutional well-being | 21 October 2025 Facebook

The Guidance and Counseling Services Center of Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) activated a multi-tiered virtual psychological support services framework across all campuses to secure the mental health and emotional resilience of its students and workforce. Designed to navigate academic stress, personal crises, and emotional difficulties, the institutional wellness program delivers remote access to Psychological First Aid (PFA), structured stress debriefing sessions, and professional one-on-one or group counseling. All clinical interactions are transitioned to a fully online mode to ensure personal privacy and convenience, with complete data security guaranteed under the statutory protections of the Data Privacy Act of 2012 and Republic Act No. 9258. Individuals seeking specialized intervention must complete an electronic appointment scheduling tracker, enabling licensed guidance counselors to audit wellness requests and establish confirmed clinical sessions via secure communication channels.





ESSU concludes charter week by integrating campus-wide ecological protection and waste management drives | 08 August 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus formalized its dedication to environmental preservation and sustainability reporting through a unified tree-planting and

environmental grooming initiative that concluded its 2025 Charter Week celebrations. Spearheaded by Vice President for Administration Dr. Rhodora C. Mendoza alongside college deans, administrative unit heads, and faculty members, the institutional conservation framework mobilized the university community despite sustained regional rainfall. Parallel to the tree-planting operations, student cohorts from distinct academic colleges synchronized efforts with non-teaching personnel to execute a systematic waste management and cleaning sweep across all campus structures and designated peripheral grounds. This organized ecological mobilization transforms institutional milestones into actionable sustainable development exercises, effectively upgrading the campus's carbon sequestration potential and reinforcing practical environmental stewardship within the student body.



17.4.2 Specific Courses on Sustainability

ESSU joins multi-agency CSC for provincial climate resilience initiative | 17 September 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) mobilized a dedicated administrative delegation led by Vice President for Academic Affairs Dr. Vicente A. Agda, Jr. to participate in

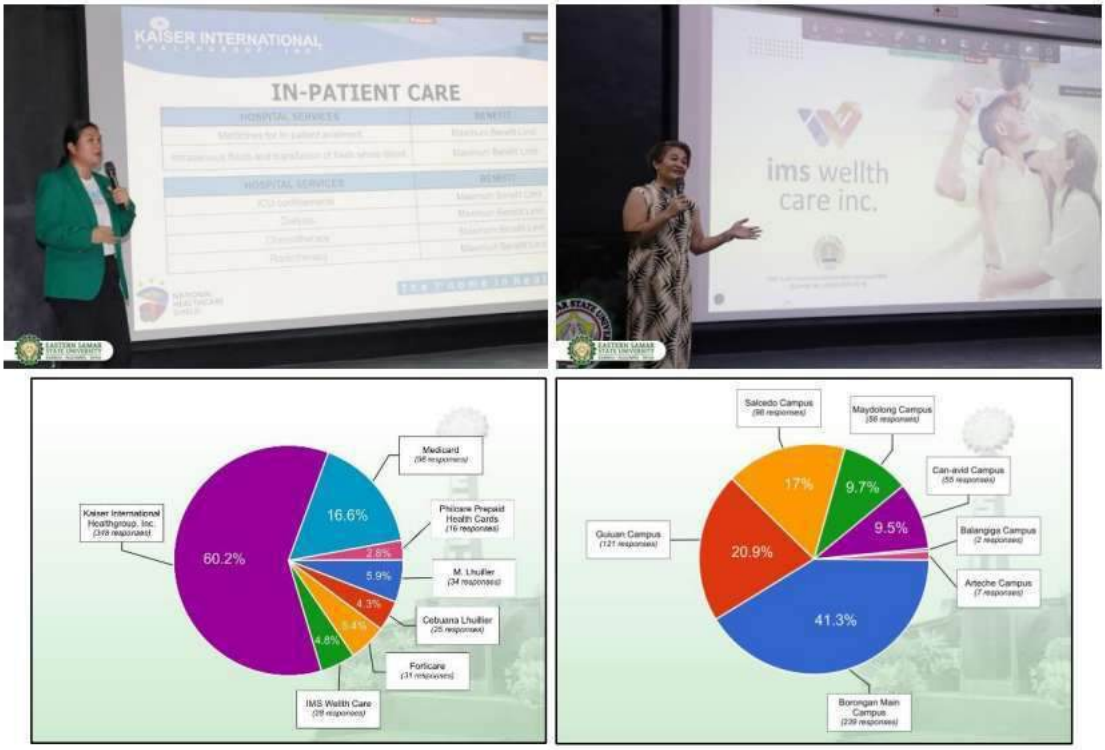
the state-led Inter-Agency Tree Growing Engagement in Barangay Hebacong, Borongan City. Spearheaded by Civil Service Commission (CSC) Eastern Samar Field Office Director Rey Albert B. Uy, the environmental preservation activity synchronized multi-agency compliance frameworks in commemoration of the 125th Philippine Civil Service Anniversary. The conservation initiative integrated environmental resource mapping from the Borongan City Environment and Natural Resources Office, which supplied 500 indigenous seedlings of Kulipapa, Bagonito, and Patsaragon species. This collaborative governance framework united university personnel, provincial officials, distinct municipal local government units, and Department of Education divisions to execute an empirical ecological protection program aimed at reinforcing regional forest cover and climate adaptation policies.



ESSU operationalizes national medical allowance circular through collective employee choice framework | 10 September 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) mobilized its permanent multi-campus workforce to execute a democratic health insurance selection process, directly operationalizing Department of Budget and Management (DBM) Circular No. 2024-6. Held at

Teatro Ibabawnon and streamed via remote communication networks to all external campuses, the administrative exercise structured product presentations from seven private health maintenance organizations. Each insurance provider calibrated healthcare coverage models against the state-mandated 7,000 Philippine Peso annual medical allowance per civilian government employee. Administrative data collection compiled 578 electronic employee ballots by the close of the voting period, confirming that Kaiser International Healthgroup, Inc. secured the majority preference with 348 votes. This fiscal execution framework successfully links state budget policies with private sector health resources, upgrading institutional employee welfare tracking and securing statutory healthcare benefits for public sector personnel.



17.4.3 SDG Education in the Wider Community

ESSU and DepEd launch joint research capacity building program for provincial teachers | 17 November 2025 Facebook

The Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus Graduate School, in a formalized partnership with the Department of Education (DepEd) Eastern Samar Division,

successfully launched the maiden edition of its Seminar-Workshop on Crafting Action and Basic Research under Project TUL-ID. Held from 11 to 13 November 2025, the three-day intensive capability-building extension program gathered school research coordinators, district coordinators, and master teachers from the province's southern school districts. Conceptualized by core faculty member Dr. Riomar G. Obliopas in response to research productivity gaps identified at the Eastern Samar Basic Education Research Forum, the initiative delivered structured instruction on research methodologies, theoretical frameworks, and data analysis techniques. Collaborative lectures from DepEd officials and ESSU Graduate School faculty enabled participants to develop complete drafts of basic research proposals aimed at resolving classroom-level issues. This strategic educational outreach provides sustainable technical upskilling to basic education professionals, establishing continuous academic support to translate scholarly data into impactful community and school policies across Eastern Samar.









ESSU-DepEd partnership builds research capacity among educators through Project TUL-Id | 10 June 2025 Facebook

BORONGAN CITY, EASTERN SAMAR, PHILIPPINES – Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through its Graduate School and Training and Extension Services Office (TESO), partnered with the Department of Education (DepEd) to officially launch Project TUL-id, an initiative designed to strengthen the research capabilities of teachers and school heads across the province.

Project TUL-id aims to provide technical upskilling opportunities in research writing, academic publishing, and the application of research findings to educational practice and policy. The initiative recognizes the important role of educators as knowledge producers and change agents capable of developing evidence-based solutions to address challenges within the basic education sector.

The partnership brings together the expertise of ESSU in graduate education, research, and extension services and the extensive educational network of DepEd. Through a series of capacity-building activities, mentoring sessions, and technical assistance programs, participating teachers and school leaders will gain enhanced competencies in conducting research, disseminating scholarly work, and translating research outputs into practical interventions that improve teaching and learning outcomes.

Discussions during the project launch emphasized the value of collaborative action in strengthening educational systems and promoting a culture of continuous learning and innovation. The initiative also seeks to bridge research and practice by equipping education professionals with the skills necessary to generate data-driven insights that can inform school improvement efforts, instructional strategies, and educational decision-making processes.

Project TUL-id advances Sustainable Development Goal 4 by supporting inclusive, equitable, and quality education through professional development opportunities for educators. The initiative also reflects the principles of Sustainable Development Goal 17 by demonstrating how partnerships between higher education institutions and government

agencies can create sustainable pathways for educational transformation and community development.

Through this collaboration, ESSU and DepEd reaffirm their shared commitment to strengthening educational excellence, expanding access to research-based knowledge, and developing a community of education professionals equipped to contribute to meaningful and lasting improvements in the learning environment.







ESSU launches free NMAT review program for aspiring physicians | 24 October 2025

Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) officially launched an inclusive educational outreach initiative providing a Free Online National Medical Admission Test (NMAT) Review Program for its current students and alumni. Organized as part of the university's institutional commitment to advanced career pathing, the specialized preparation course equips aspiring medical professionals with the necessary analytical skills and knowledge to pass the national medical boards. Interested applicants must complete a comprehensive electronic registration screening form, with total class enrollment strictly capped at 100 participants to guarantee

optimal instructional quality. This strategic community-based education program removes financial barriers to high-level professional test preparation, effectively expanding access to medical education and strengthening regional healthcare workforce development.



17.4.4 Sustainable Literacy

State university extension project delivers community literacy programs to local elementary pupils | 09 February 2025 Facebook

The Bachelor of Elementary Education (BEED) faculty of Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Guiuan Campus successfully deployed its grassroots literacy outreach initiative under the institutional extension framework "BEED LINE." Executed across multiple localized zones, the community program commenced with morning educational sessions at the St. Genevieve Covered Court serving 20 elementary pupils, followed by an afternoon replication in Barangay Sapao that reached 10 additional youth participants. University faculty facilitators Sheralyn Lacay and Ma. Christine P. Daganio led structured instructional tracks focusing on primary reading and writing literacy development, supported by Dr. Cenby Eppie Gaytos, Lorelin Dagale, and pre-service BEED student volunteers. This targeted community

outreach bridges regional learning gaps by providing marginalized primary school students with essential academic skills, operationalizing the university's mandate to deliver inclusive educational resources to the wider community.



Regional economic development director joins ESSU executives to align provincial extension policies | 17 September 2025 Facebook

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus hosted a strategic coordination meeting and facility visit with the Department of Economy, Planning, and Development (DEPDev) Regional Office VIII Director and concurrent ESSU Board Member, Meylene C. Rosales. University Vice Presidents Dr. Rhodora C. Mendoza, Dr. Aris A. Lapada, Dr. Vicente A. Agda, Jr., and Dr. Jocelyn S. Castro led academic deans and administrative directors in receiving the government planning delegation at the President's Conference Room. The high-level dialogue centered on structuring institutional coordination pathways, specifically focusing on securing state planning support for the university's localized community extension programs. This formalized regional partnership aims to directly counter economic vulnerabilities within the province, utilizing collaborative government policy frameworks to

translate academic research into actionable livelihood interventions for vulnerable communities across Eastern Samar.

